

Instrument

The app is the faceplate of a small machine. It shows the signal path from your voice to your to-do list, and which stage a note is at, the same path the sounds already trace.

WHAT IT BETS ON

That trust comes from seeing the chain. If you can see recorder, capture, transcript, agent and Todoist as five lamps, you always know where a note is and where one stopped.

AT A GLANCE

Structure	A "now" screen with the signal path and one large readout. The log lives in a sheet you pull up from the bottom.
Autonomy	Acts on its own. Each note keeps a trace: every stage with its time and result, like a flight recorder.
Type	SF Pro for labels, SF Mono for anything measured: times, durations, battery, counts.
Colour	Near-black, warm off-white, one amber for "signal present". Red appears only for a broken chain.
Sound and touch	The full machinery, including the working ticks. Each sound has a lamp: what you hear is what lights up.
Lock Screen	A Live Activity per recording showing the five lamps filling in. A Lock Screen widget shows chain health between recordings.

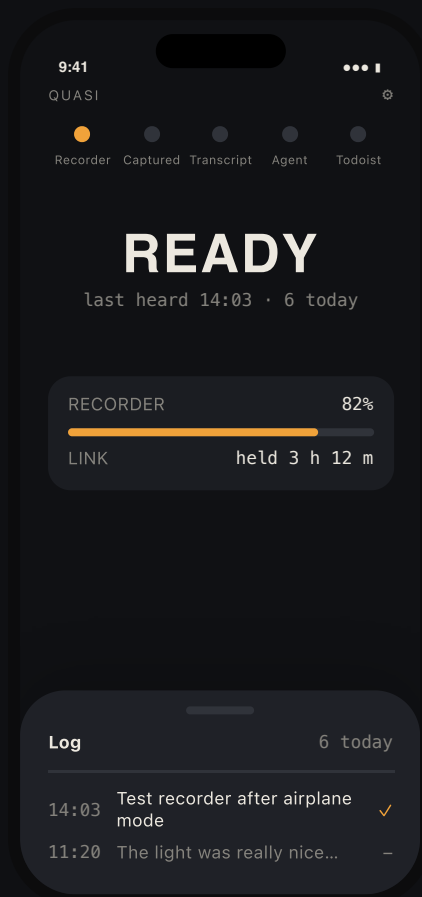
COLOUR



TYPE

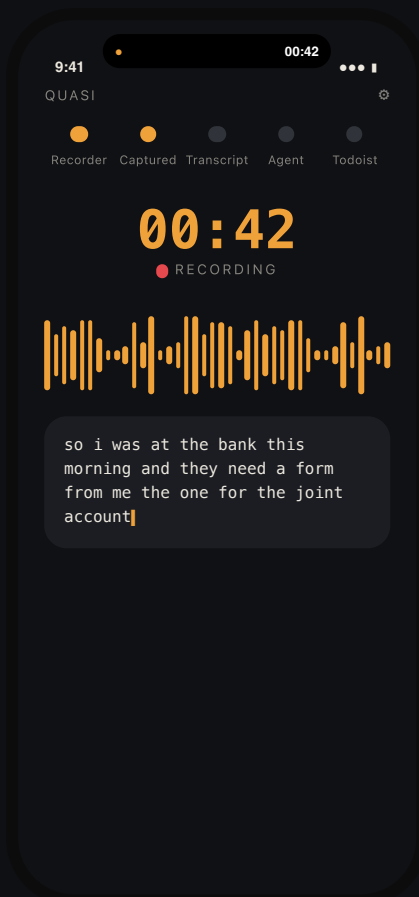
Call the dentist, tomorrow
at three

The three screens you would see most



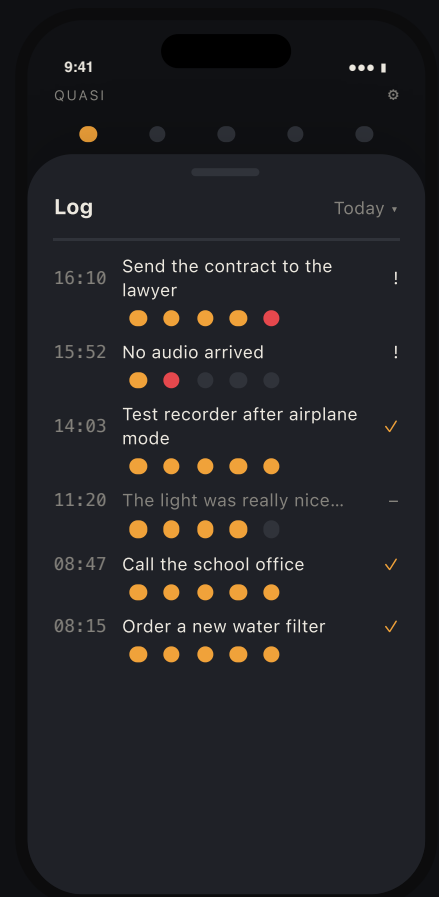
NOW: IDLE

Five lamps for the chain, one word for the state. The newest entries of the log peek up from the bottom.



NOW: RECORDING

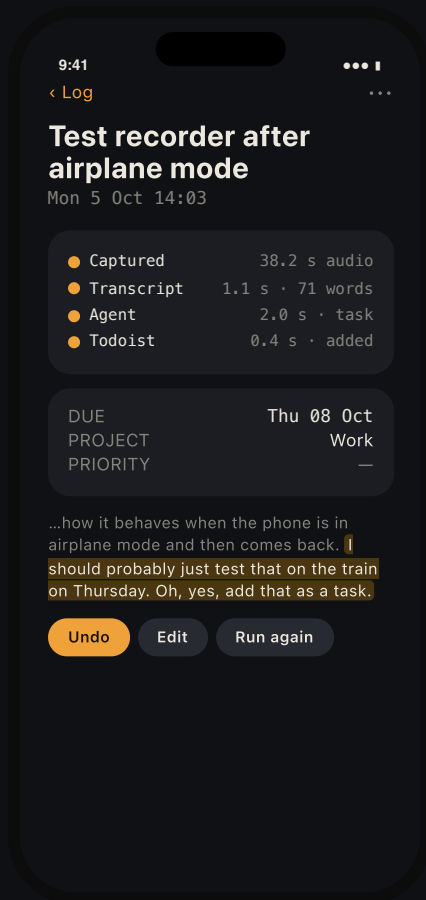
The readout becomes the timer and the second lamp lights, at the moment you hear the opening notes.



THE LOG, PULLED UP

Every row carries its own five lamps, so you can see at a glance how far each note got and where one stopped.

A note's trace, the Lock Screen, and settings



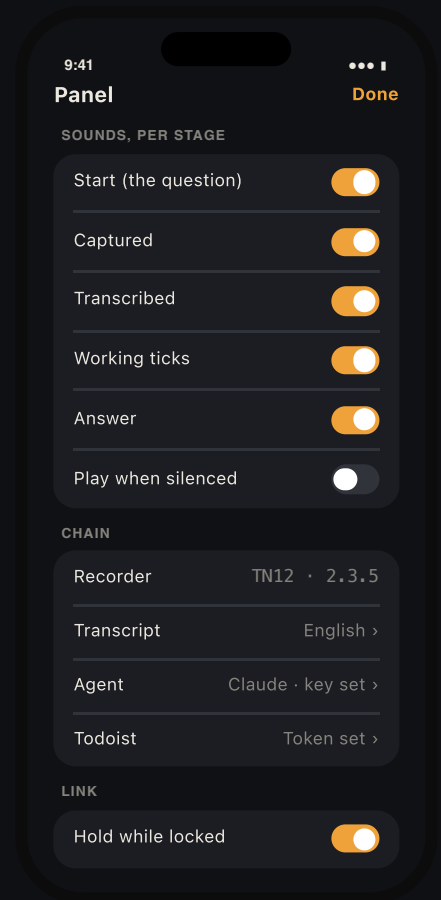
A NOTE: ITS TRACE

What happened at each stage and how long it took. "Run again" re-reads the note after you change a setting or a key.



LOCK SCREEN: THE LAMPS

The same five lamps fill in as the sounds play. A small widget shows that the chain is healthy when nothing is recording.



SETTINGS: THE PANEL

Settings follow the chain too: one row per stage, and a switch for each sound so you can thin out the middle once you trust it.

Why this direction, and what it costs

GROUNDING IN THE RESEARCH

You already built a language in sound: a start, two mechanical steps, working ticks and an answer. This direction gives each sound a matching light, so the screen, the Lock Screen and the sounds all describe the same five-stage path.

The agent guidance in the research asks that a system's state be readable at a glance and that every action leave an audit trail. A per-note trace is the most literal form of that, and it is also the best debugging tool while the project is still changing weekly.

The research found almost nothing on how comparable apps show device state. This direction answers that gap directly instead of hiding it: the recorder and the link are the first lamp.

TRUE OF ALL THREE DIRECTIONS

- The recorder is found automatically; keys are entered once and kept in the keychain.
- "Your note is safe" is said first in every failure, because the recorder keeps the full copy.
- The Live Activity belongs to a recording and ends as a receipt. Today's permanent "connected" banner goes away.

NOT SETTLED YET

The mock-ups are drawn by hand in HTML to show structure and character; they are not final visual design and no screenshots of other apps were consulted. One technical question affects all three: whether iOS lets the app start a Live Activity when a recording begins while the phone is locked. Apple's guidance assumes it is started from the app or by a push. This needs a small test before the Lock Screen design is relied on.

RISKS AND COSTS

- The research did not find sourced examples of this dark, hardware-like style; it rests on judgement, not precedent.
- Most of the day nothing is recording, so the large readout says "READY" most of the time. The research names this as the main risk of a live-first screen.
- It is the furthest from stock iOS, so it is the most custom drawing to build and keep up to date.
- A widget for chain health works around Apple's rule that a Live Activity is for a session, not a status.

WHAT WOULD BE BUILT FIRST

- The five-lamp chain as one reusable view (app, Lock Screen, log rows)
- The now screen with the readout and the log sheet
- The per-note trace with timings
- Per-stage sound switches

- Lock Screen text can be hidden.
- Every state is available by sound, by touch and by sight; each can be switched off.
- Sounds follow the silent switch unless you choose otherwise.